

DESIGN RATIONALE

Locates Table Redesign

Design 1 → Design 2

Design 1 optimized for showing all the data. Design 2 optimizes for getting a person to the answer → fewer columns, clearer status, filters and search up front, and an accessible, branded shell around it.

01 Information density & column strategy

- **Cut ~14 columns down to 6 by default.**

- Design 1 showed every identifier at once (Batch ID, Locate ID, SEDOL, ISIN, RIC, CUSIP, Ticker, BBG Ticker...): a data dump with nowhere for the eye to land.
- Design 2 shows only the columns needed to scan and decide (Date, Status, Type, Security, Qty Req, Qty Appr) and folds the rest behind “Add columns” + row-detail drawer.

Why — *Progressive disclosure → show the 20% of data people use 80% of the time, keep the rest one click away.*

- **Merged the redundant identifier columns into one “Security” cell.** Ticker, BBG Ticker, and Security were three columns saying nearly the same thing.

Why — *Removes horizontal scroll and repetition.*

02 Scannability

- **Added row breathing room (taller rows, more padding).** Design 1’s rows are crammed edge-to-edge.

Why — *Scan speed and reduced error → important when the data is financial.*

- **Status now uses an icon + colour + word, not just an uppercase word.**

Why — *Lets you triage by shape and colour at a glance → no longer depends on just text*

- **Right-aligned the columns.**

Why — *Consistency & easier to compare numbers correctly when their digits line up.*

03 Findability & actions

- **Added four stat cards (All / Approved / Pending / Rejected).**

Why — *They double as an at-a-glance summary + one-click filters → simplify the most common task.*

- **Added a real search field.** Design 1 had cryptic per-column filter inputs (“Enter value”).

Why — *One search box covering all is more intuitive than hunting the right column.*

- **Promoted “New Locate Request” to a clear primary button, top-right.**

Why — *The primary action should look primary and sit where people expect it.*

04 Hierarchy & orientation

- **Added a page title and one-line description.**
Why — Tells the user where they are and what the screen is for.
- **Added the helper line (“Showing key columns. Click a row…”).**
Why — The column reduction only works if people know the hidden data is still reachable.

05 Visual & brand

- **Applied Scotiabank branding (red header, wordmark, avatar).**
Why — Trust and consistency so it reads as an official internal tool, not a raw database view.
- **Flat styling.** Subtle corners, no heavy navy header bar, consistent greys.
Why — A calmer, professional surface keeps attention on the data, not the chrome.

06 Accessibility — the layer that isn’t visible

- **Fixed colour contrast on status text and muted values to pass WCAG AA.**
- **Made filter cards keyboard-operable with announced state, focus rings, & Enter-to-open on rows.**
Why — A bank tool should be able to be operable by keyboard and screen reader.

Summary

Design 1 optimized for **showing all the data**. Design 2 optimizes for **getting a person to the answer**. Fewer columns, clear status, filters and search up front, and an accessible, branded shell around it.